I/1532601/2023

भारतसरकार/Government of India
वित्तमंत्रालय /Ministry of Finance
कार्यालय/Office of
मुख्य सीमाशुल्क आयुक्त
THE CHIEF COMMISSIONER OF CUSTOMS
मुंबईअंचल-III /MUMBAI ZONE III
छत्रपति शिवाजी महाराज अंतर्राष्ट्रीय हवाई अड्डा,
मुंबई-400099
CSM International Airport, Mumbai-400099

भारत सरकार

भारतीय सीमाशुल्क

Date:09-11-2023

Minutes of the Customs Clearance Facilitation Committee (CCFC) Meeting held on 31.10.2023

Meeting of the Customs Clearance Facilitation Committee (CCFC) chaired by Smt. Prachi Saroop, Chief Commissioner of Customs, Mumbai Zone-III was held on 31.10.2023 at 1500 hrs. in the Conference room, Air Cargo Complex, Sahar, Mumbai.

2. Following representatives of the Partner Government Agencies (PGAs) and other stakeholders were present in the meeting:

Sr. No.	**Name of the Representative (Shri/Smt./Ms.)**	**Name of the Organization**
1.	Neha Nilesh Doshi	Department of Posts
2.	R.S. Pal	Department of Posts
3.	P.N. Wasnik	Textiles Committee
4.	M.K. Meena	Plant Quarantine
5.	Pramod Patil	CDSCO
6.	Manita Churi	CDSCO
7.	V. Sooraj	CDSCO
8.	Dushyant Mulani	Brihanmumbai Customs Broker Association (BCBA)
9.	Sanjeev Harale	BCBA
10.	Ketan Desai	BCBA
11.	Paresh Sangrani	BCBA
12.	Chaitaly Mehta	BCBA
13.	Mark S. Fernandes	Shipping & Logistics Committee
14.	Baqir Agha	MIAL
15.	Mohamed Nasir	MIAL
16.	Amit Kedam	MIAL
17.	Nandan Kanchan	MIAL
18.	V.P. Salunke	Air India Airport Services Ltd.
19.	Hiren Joshi	Air India Airport Services Ltd.

20.	Kamlesh C. Sawant	Air India Airport Services Ltd.
21.	Pradeep Nair	RSSL
22.	Shailesh Sharma	Air Cargo Agents Association of India(ACAAI)
23.	Rajen Bhatia	Air Cargo Agents Association of India(ACAAI)

The Customs department was represented by the following officers:

Sr. No.	**Name (Shri/Smt/Ms.)**	**Designation**	**Commissionerate**
1.	Ranjit Kumar	Pr. Commissioner	Export
2.	G. Shiril Saroj	Commissioner	Import
3.	Harish Dharnia	Commissioner	APSC
4.	Nilank Kumar	Commissioner	General
5.	Satish Kumar	Addl. Commissioner	General
6.	Pawan Kumar Khetan	Addl. Commissioner	Import
7.	Mahendra K Sharma	Addl. Commissioner	Export
8.	Sarika Shah	Addl. Commissioner	CCO
9.	Mohan Singh Dorai	Addl. Commissioner	APSC
10.	Davinder Singh Rana	Addl. Commissioner	Import
11.	V. I. Singh	Joint Commissioner	General
12.	Jitesh Jain	Deputy Commissioner	Import
13.	Praveen Kumar	Deputy Commissioner	CCO
14.	Mahesh Parmar	Asstt. Commissioner	Export

3. The Chief Commissioner of Customs, Mumbai Zone-III welcomed the participants.

4. During the course of Power Point Presentation, the dwell time performance of Customs and other agencies for the month of July, August and September were highlighted.

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DWELL TIME (in Hrs) COMPARISON WITH PGAs (JULY to SEPT. 2023)								
Agency Code	Month	Total BE	Inward-Submission	Submission-Assessment	Assessment-Payment of duty	Assessment-Registration	Registration-OOC	PGA Time (in Hrs.)
FSSAI	July	153	-30.22	51.5	44.42	182.06	72.68	**184.84**
	August	158	-19.74	22.79	40.28	74.94	87.9	**161.41**
	Sept.	93	-13.77	23.87	50.19	137.28	80.62	**231.5**
ADC	July	4149	-6.59	17.24	52.75	51.05	23.61	**63.42**
	August	3324	-1.78	18.63	48.79	45.56	19.27	**47.76**
	Sept.	3060	-6.6	12.66	47.29	50.78	13.57	**51.75**
WCCB	July	104	-19.69	8.78	48.59	78.88	18.11	**36.45**
	August	92	6.99	8.18	128.96	121.65	53.5	**33.51**
	Sept.	88	-8.22	19.98	81.26	56.21	42.84	**45.99**
PQ	July	204	-3.12	51.88	79.92	230.98	103.61	**365.48**
	August	233	-14.63	25.36	69.69	407.51	115.91	**754.73**
	Sept.	185	-13.36	39.46	89.62	370.59	151.88	**387.44**
AQ	July	222	-19.86	9.62	50.25	100.09	23.1	**101.82**
	August	204	-31.77	8.41	74.61	124.88	29.81	**122.91**
	Sept.	195	-26.59	11.47	60.84	100.72	24.7	**111.72**

5. The Chair enquired about the high dwell time for FSSAI, PQ and AQ (as reflected in table above).

a) The representative of PQ informed that the minimum time required for testing of the seeds in lab for sowing purpose is 1 (One) week and for virus testing, it is 30 days. He stated that the perishable plants and fruits are cleared on the same day. The representative of PQ provided a copy of standard timeline for Plant Quarantine Activities for import of plants/plant materials. (Copy attached)

b) Shri Pramod Patil, representative of CDSCO (Central Drugs Standard control Organisation) submitted that they have informed their superiors about the issue and they are actively working to reduce the dwell time.

c) The BCBA raised the issue of absence of WCCB and AQ representatives on a daily basis at the Cargo Complex, highlighting that many a times they have to go to Belapur Office of the WCCB for getting the clearances. Since, no representative was present from WCCB and AQ, The Commissioner (Import) and Commissioner (General) were requested to look into the matter and write to the representatives of WCCB and AQ, seeking a timely response from WCCB and AQ.

6. The representative of Shipping and Logistics Committee highlighted the fact that they have to pay high detention and demurrage charges as they are unaware about the real-time location of goods whicg affects the clearance of goods. MIAL informed that the demurrage charges start after

the segregation of goods. The Chair requested the Commissioner (Import) to form and head a Committee including the concerned Addl. Commissioner (General), 2 members of BCBA and MIAL each and 2 officers of Customs nominated by Commissioner (Import) as members of the Committee to look into the issue and submit a report by 15th November.

7. The representatives of Postal Department highlighted the issue of disposal of valuable articles that are lying at APSO (Foreign). The Commissioner (APSC) was requested to expedite the process of auction of these articles as per the CBIC disposal manual.

8. Thereafter, pending issues from earlier CCFC Meeting held on 22.02.2023 (Copy enclosed) were taken up for discussion:

Old Agenda Point – 1

The APSC Commissioner highlighted that no Public Notice or SOP issued in this regard, as live testing of the application is being held by DG Systems and they will issue as a PN or SOP as soon as the issue is resolved.

[Action to be taken by APSC Commissionerate]

Old Agenda Point – 2

MIAL informed that Pre - Engineering Building work has started and is about 70% Complete and further the work will be completed by May 2024. They informed that the detailed drawing and layout plan of Import Cargo terminal 2 has been prepared and the project work is scheduled to start from April 2024. Along with this, modification of FPS (Fire Protection Safety) has started and will be completed by May, 2024.

[Action to be taken by MIAL & The Commissioner (General), ACC, Mumbai]

New Agenda Point No. 1 - Improvement in Infrastructure and Service Levels required at MIAL at Air Cargo Complex, Mumbai

The Chair requested Commissioner (General) to look into the issue and submit a report by 31st December 2023 in light of increased facilitation of Bills of Entry.

[Action to be taken by MIAL & The Commissioner (General), ACC, Mumbai]

New Agenda Point No. 2: Issues faced with PGA – Delay in granting of NOC/ Permission - Dual use NOC takes 10-20 days from the office of Dy. Drug Controller along with the manual submission of documents, resulting in payment of huge detention and demurrage charges.

The matter about the Assistant Drug Controller, despite being a partner on SWIFT (Single Window Interface for Facilitation of Trade) and being on EDI system, had directed the importers to submit necessary documents manually, was highlighted. The CDSCO representative Shri Pramod Patil stated that, the practice of calling for necessary documents is for their own

database. The matter was discussed and the reasons were not found justifiable as it led to delays and increased costs. The Chair directed that the practice of asking for manual submission of documents be stopped, in view of data being available electronically and requested the Commissioner (Import) to guide the CDSCO officers in retrieving the data from their end.

New Agenda Point No. 3:

- Delay in Faceless Assessment
- Wrong examination order given
- Speaking Order not being issued.
- BE kept aside on low priority.
- Reduction in number of queries.

As informed by Commissioner (Import), these issues are already being raised on the NAC (National Assessment Commissioner) platform. The Chair requested the Commissioner (Import) to look into the matter in case any such issue comes up again. It was decided to close the point.

New Agenda Point No. 4: Non Allocation of Bill of Entry – After generation of BE Number by system, it remains pending for allocation to FAG for 2-3 days.

The Chair informed the trade representatives that the daily monitoring of Bills of Entry is being done at senior levels. Since the issues have been solved, it was agreed to close the point.

New Agenda Point No. 5: Improvement in Anonymized Escalation Mechanism – AEM Module is enabled only in cases where there is 24 hour delay after Inward (Arrival) of Cargo, while still not enabled in cases of Advance filing of BE and Ex-Bond BE.

Since, the issue did not pertain to Mumbai Customs Zone III, it was agreed to close the point and bring the matter to notice of the Board.

New Agenda Point No. 6: Requirement of Gate Scanner at ACC for Export Cargo

BCBA informed the requirement of Gate Scanner at ACC for Export Cargo. MIAL informed that only 3 cases of ODC (Over-dimensional Cargo) packages have come to ACC in the past two months.It was further informed that in all the three cases,clearance was done by MIAL in 30 minutes and there was no hindrance to the export clearance. Further, it was submitted that installation of Gate Scanner is not needed. Therefore,it was agreed to close the point.

New Agenda Point No. 7: Online Goods Registration of SB – Facility for Registration for Export SB to be carried out through Exporter/ Customs Broker Office has not been activated yet.

Since the issue has already been taken up with the Board, it was agreed to close the point.

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New Agenda Point No. 8: RMS facilitation SB to be provided LEO directly by Shed AO/ Supdt.

Since the issue has already been taken up with the Board, it was agreed to close the point.

New Agenda Point No. 9:- Post Arrival Amendments should not result in re-assessment of BE – BE filed in advance, duly facilitated under RMS, and assessed by RMS are subjected to re-assessment, when there is change in any of the IGM or arrival details.

Since the matter did not pertain to Mumbai Customs Zone III, it was agreed to close the point and bring the matter to notice of the Board.

The Chair directed the attention of all to the issue of many unclaimed /uncleared cargo lying unattended, highlighting the fact that some of the cargo may be hazardous and pendency of its disposal also leads to non realisation of revenue. It was requested to Commissioner (General), Commissioner (Import), Commissioner (Export) and representatives of MIAL to expedite the auction and the clearance of unclaimed/uncleared cargo in accordance with Boards instruction and circulars.

Meeting ended with a vote of thanks.

This issues with the approval of the Chief Commissioner, Mumbai Customs Zone III.

Signed by
Praveen Kumar
PRAVEEN KUMAR
Date: 09-11-2023 13:01:51
DEPUTY COMMISSIONER
DC/AC-I-O/o Chief Commissioner-Customs-Zone-III-Mumbai

Copy to:

1. The Under Secretary (Cus.IV), CBIC, North Block, New Delhi.
2. All Pr. Commissioner/Commissioner of Customs, Mumbai Zone-III.
3. All the Members of CCFC (Through e-mail).
4. The DC/EDI, ACC (With a request to upload the minutes on the zonal website)